Case study · Product Management

# Swiggy built a health tab, then surrounded it with mechanics that work against it

A full 8-stage teardown of Swiggy's EatRight flow, order placement, and checkout — showing what happens when a platform's growth mechanics run directly against the goal its own feature claims to serve.

Product Teardown | Consumer / Food-Tech | Domain-Led Analysis

**Anubhav Kapoor**

| Swiggy | EatRight tab → order → gamified checkout | 12 screens, own account |
|---|---|---|
| Product | Flow torn down | Evidence |

**Self-initiated, Sept 2026**

## READ THIS FIRST — 60-SECOND SUMMARY

### THE QUESTION

Swiggy has a dedicated health tab, EatRight, showing kcal and protein on dishes. That's the setup. The real question is what happens after — does the rest of the app respect what a health-conscious user came to do, or does it override that intent to hit its own numbers?

### WHAT I FOUND

EatRight itself is real and useful at a glance — kcal/protein figures directly on dish cards. But once a user starts ordering, the surrounding checkout flow works against that same goal twice: a full-screen subscription modal blocks checkout until it's dismissed, and the post-order screen leads with a scratch-card game ahead of the order status itself. Checkout also surfaces a carousel of steeply discounted, non-health items with a deal-expiry countdown — opt-in, not forced, but placed at the exact moment a health-conscious user is finalising a considered order. None of this is about health. It's about what the rest of the product optimises for once the health-conscious moment is over.

### THE BUSINESS TENSION

Line the findings up and a pattern appears: tempt with a discount on unrelated items, interrupt the task with a subscription pitch, then gamify the exact moment the user succeeded at their goal. That's a variable-reward engagement strategy running in direct tension with a user whose actual goal is to order less often, not more.

**MY RECOMMENDATION**

Keep the checkout subscription interstitial and the gamification prompts out of EatRight-originated orders, and stop showing them non-health discounts. Do this before spending any more effort deepening the badges themselves.

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**WHY THIS EXISTS**

## Health is the setup. The growth mechanics are the story.

It would be easy to write this as another "the health feature is incomplete" teardown — EatRight shows a number, doesn't explain it, ends there. That's true, and it's in here. But it's not the actual finding. Once you start ordering through EatRight, the rest of the app works against the same goal in two clear ways — it blocks your checkout with an unrelated subscription pitch, and it turns the moment you finish your order into a game — plus a third, softer one: it tempts you toward unrelated, steeply discounted items right when you're finalising a considered order. None of that is a health-feature problem. It's what the platform optimises for once the health-conscious moment is over, and it happens to land on exactly the user who came in with the clearest, most specific intent of anyone ordering that day.

> *"I want to have Chinese food today, because today is my anniversary, and need some filling and tasty food because since morning I was busy in work and travelling, now want to enjoy my food — and budget is 400 only, with 1 drink."*
>
> — a client I work with on a structured nutrition plan, six months in

Same person who otherwise tracks protein and calories closely — on a different day, with a different context, wanting something entirely different from "healthy." That's the whole thesis in one message: a badge that means something on a normal Tuesday means nothing on an anniversary, and no platform I tore down has a way to tell the difference.

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STAGE 1 · FRAME THE TEARDOWN

## What I expected, and what I found

Before opening the app, I expected EatRight to be a shallow rebrand — existing dietary filters (High Protein, Low Cal, No Added Sugar) bundled under one marketing-friendly name, with little real product work behind it. That expectation turned out to be partly right and partly wrong. The card-level kcal/protein data is real and genuinely useful at a glance — that part isn't a rebrand. What I didn't expect was to find the more interesting problem sitting one level below the feature itself: not in EatRight, but in what the rest of the app does to a user the moment they try to act on it.

**Goal** — evaluate a specific feature bet: is Swiggy's EatRight goal-aware, and does the surrounding product respect the intent it invites?

**User** — a health-conscious orderer tracking calories, protein, or macros against a personal target, deciding what to order for dinner tonight.

**Job to be done** — "help me order something that still fits my target today, without having to do the math myself — and don't work against me once I've decided."

I asked five people, independently, whether they trust the calorie or protein numbers these apps show. None of them fully did — for five different reasons, none of them prompted by the others. That's the baseline this teardown starts from.

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STAGE 2 · MAP THE BUSINESS

## Where the incentives actually point

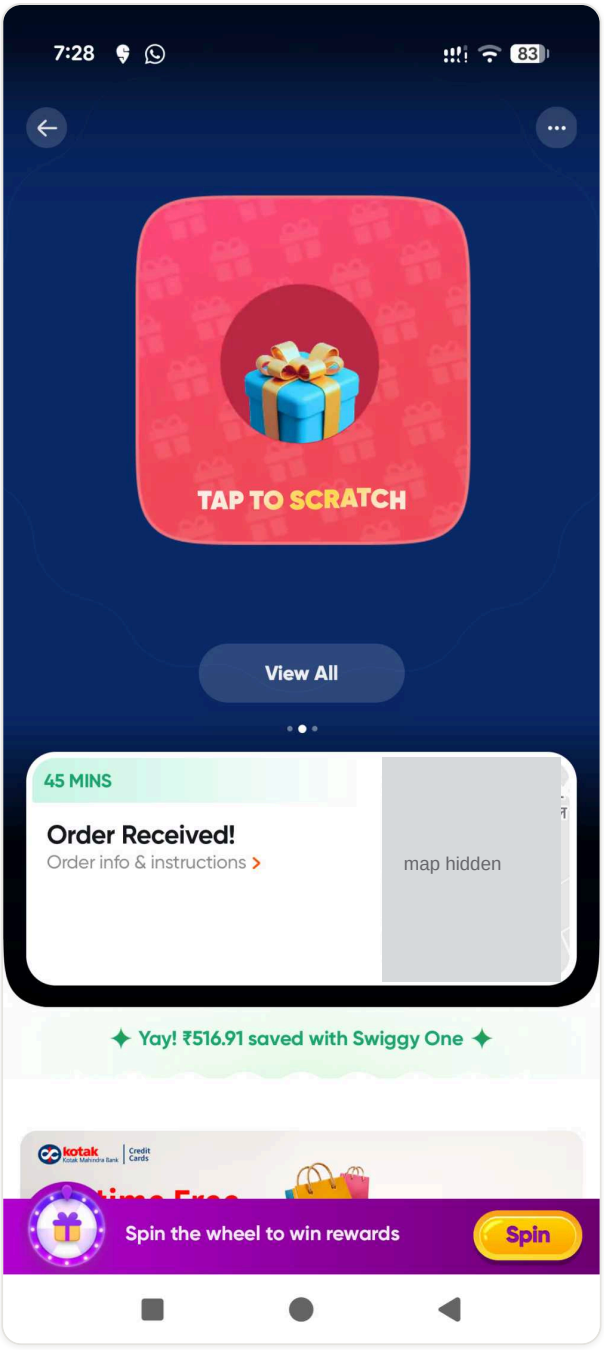
Swiggy's core loop is order frequency × average order value, monetised through commission, delivery fees, a subscription (One / One BLCK), and advertising — visible directly in the credit-card and cashback ads placed on the order-details screen.

| METRIC LAYER | MY INFERENCE | WHAT IT'S BASED ON | CONFIDENCE |
|---|---|---|---|
| North star | Orders × AOV, per active user | Standard delivery-platform economics; coupon and delivery-fee mechanics | M |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | throughout checkout are all frequency/AOV levers | |
| L1 | One / One BLCK subscription conversion and retention | A full-screen interstitial upsell for One BLCK appeared mid-checkout — that's a heavier placement than a passive banner, suggesting it's a tracked, prioritised funnel | M |
| L2 | Post-order re-engagement (scratch card / spin-the-wheel completion rate) | Both gamified elements appear immediately after order confirmation — classic variable-reward placement to drive the next session | M |
| Guardrail | Overall order frequency shouldn't fall if EatRight is expanded | Inferred from the structural tension described above — a rational team would guardrail against this before expanding the feature's reach | L |

**THE TENSION, STATED PLAINLY**

A scratch card and a spin-the-wheel prompt appear on the screen immediately after a health-conscious order is placed. Variable-reward mechanics are a well-established way to drive compulsive re-engagement — which is in direct tension with a user whose actual goal is to order less often, not more. This is a gamification loop timed to the exact moment right after the user has "succeeded" at their goal for the day, and any business case for a goal-aware EatRight layer has to reckon with that placement, not just the badges themselves.




Immediately after order confirmation: a "Tap to scratch" reward card, followed further down by a "Spin the wheel to win rewards" banner — both landing right after a health-conscious order was completed.

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STAGE 3 · WALK THE FLOW

## A separate path, one navigation layer deep

Home (default tab) — no nutrition data shown by default. Sub-nav row: OFFERS | BOLT | **EATRIGHT** | KHAO GULLY — a second nav layer just to reach health content

**Path A — Home**

1. Search
2. Restaurant
3. Menu
4. Item
5. Cart
6. Checkout
7. Tracking

   Drop-off risk: zero health signal the whole way

**Path B — EatRight**

1. Curated protein/kcal cards
2. Restaurant (EatRight Dishes filter)
3. Item
4. Cart
5. Checkout — drop-off risk: a discounted, non-health carousel with an expiry countdown competes for attention here
6. Checkout — drop-off risk: full-screen subscription upsell interrupts checkout
7. Order confirmation — drop-off risk: gamified scratch card / spin wheel nudges toward re-ordering immediately
8. Tracking

EatRight is a separate destination in the sub-navigation, not a lens applied to Home — a user has to know to look for it. And the flow adds two things that work directly against a goal-driven order: a discounted, non-health carousel timed to a considered order, and a post-order reward loop designed to bring the user back for another order.

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STAGE 4 · SCREEN TEARDOWNS

## Zones, intents, and the evidence

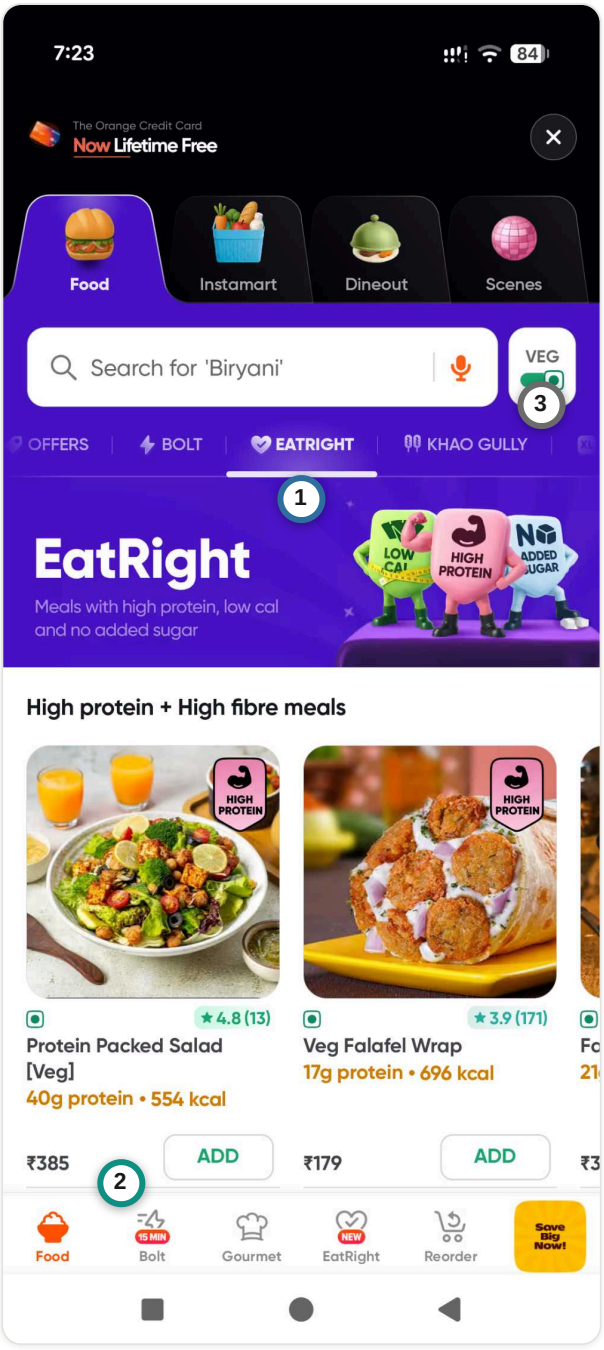
Six intents, defined once here and used consistently below:

- **Orient** — tells the user where they are or what's happening
- **Progress** — moves the user toward the task they came to do
- **Reassure** — reduces the perceived risk of the next step
- **Extract** — captures value for the business
- **Retain** — pulls the user back for a future session
- **Comply** — exists because policy, legal risk, or self-protection requires it

The screens below aren't shown in capture order — they're organised to make the actual finding legible: what Swiggy built first (a real, if shallow, health feature), and what it built around that feature afterward (a discount carousel timed to tempt a goal-driven user, plus two real points where the platform interrupts what the user came to do — none of which have anything to do with health).

## 4.1 — The setup: a real health feature, with nothing behind it

**Zones on this screen:** the Content zone carries the kcal/protein badges directly. No explanatory zone — nothing answering "why is this tagged EatRight" — exists anywhere in this capture.




| # | ELEMENT | INTENT | WHY HERE / NOW / THIS FORM / THIS WEIGHT |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | EATRIGHT tab, active with underline | **Orient** | Sits in a horizontal sub-nav row (Offers/Bolt/EatRight/Khao Gully) below the main tab bar — a second layer of navigation a user has to find before reaching any health content. |
| 2 | "40g protein · 554 kcal" badge | **Reassure** | Figures shown directly on the card, in the same visual weight as price, right below the dish name — decision-relevant data given real prominence. |
| 3 | VEG toggle | **Comply** | Persistent top-right, independent of the EatRight tab — dietary preference and nutrition goal are treated as two entirely separate systems that don't talk to each other. |

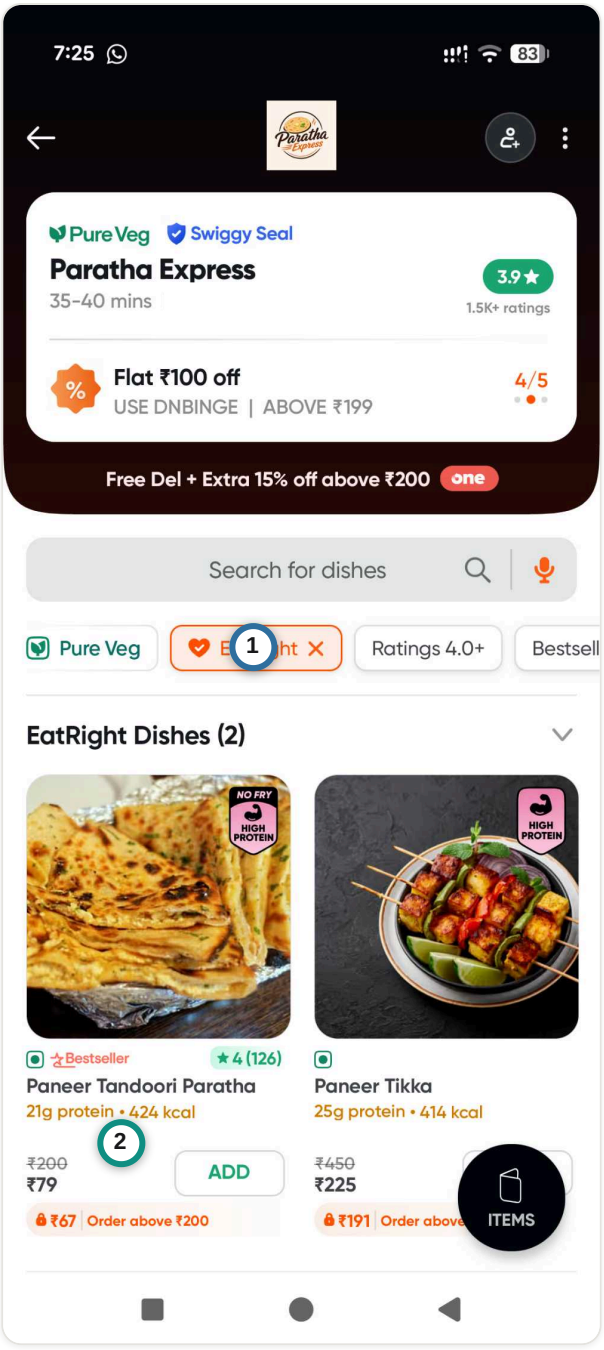
**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Kcal and protein shown directly on the card is genuinely useful at a glance — a real, working feature, not vapourware. But the badge is a number and nothing else: no explanation of how it was calculated, no sense of whether it's a confident figure or a rough estimate. This is the entire feature. Everything from here is what Swiggy built around it.

> *"I don't trust it. No way to verify."*
>
> — Abhinav, on calorie and protein numbers shown before ordering

> *"Being a dietitian, I do check calorie and protein numbers, but I don't blindly trust them. I also look at the ingredients and serving size, because sometimes the numbers look fine, but the actual product turns out a little different. Calories or protein is one factor, but ingredients and overall food quality matter just as much."*
>
> — Jay, a practising dietitian, on why she still doesn't take the number at face value

Worth sitting with who's saying that. Someone trained to read exactly this kind of data still won't take the number alone as enough.



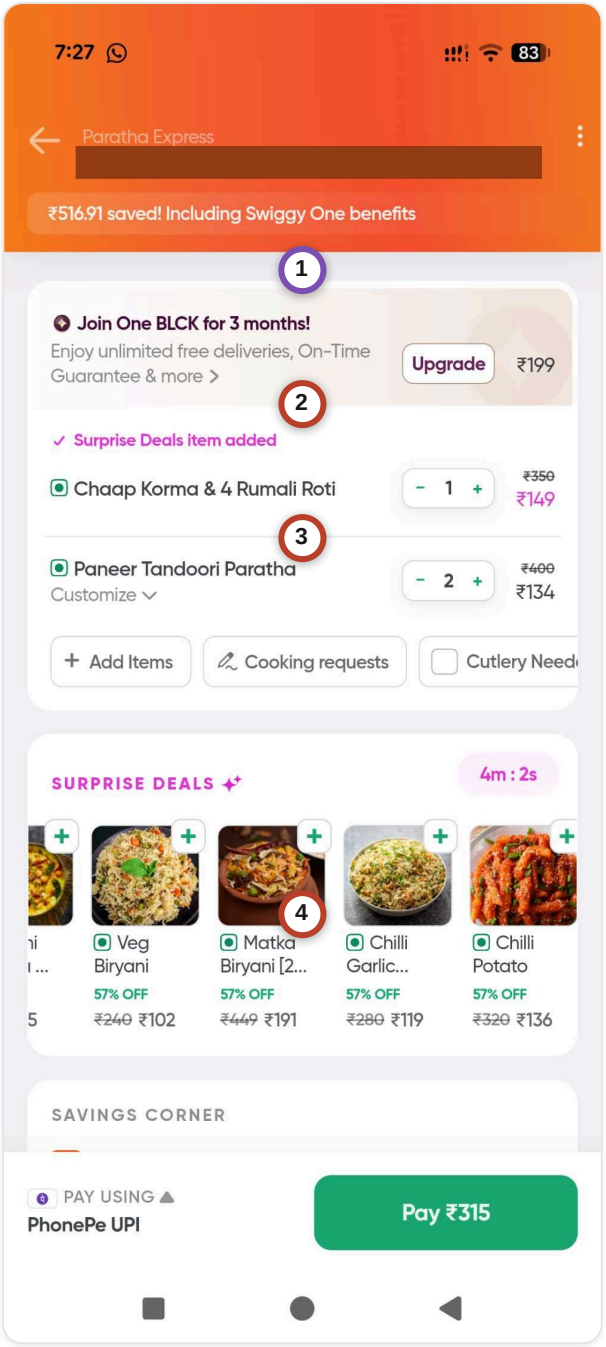

The same pattern repeats on a restaurant page — "EatRight Dishes (2)" rendered as a collapsible count, the identical UI pattern used for "Bestsellers (12)." A nutrition claim gets treated as equivalent in kind to a popularity metric.

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*The single most interesting decision across both screens: EatRight sits in a secondary sub-nav row, one level below the primary tab bar, and is styled throughout like any other filter or campaign rather than a distinct kind of information. The likely reason is that health is one initiative among several competing for the same shelf space. I'd still promote it, because a feature this easy to miss is a feature most sessions will never reach — but that's a placement problem, not the interesting part of this teardown. The interesting part is what happens next.*

## 4.2 — Discounted temptation: a checkout designed for a different goal

**Zones on this screen:** the Peripheral zone crowds out the Content zone at exactly the point a user is reviewing their own cart — three separate monetisation elements sit above the order itself.




| # | ELEMENT | INTENT | WHY HERE / NOW / THIS FORM / THIS WEIGHT |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | "₹516.91 saved! Including Swiggy One benefits" | **Retain** | Top of the checkout scroll, quantified and prominent — reinforces subscription value at the exact moment a user is most receptive to a savings message. |
| 2 | "Join One BLCK for 3 months" banner | **Extract** | A second, higher subscription tier pitched immediately below the first savings message — layering two monetisation asks back to back. |

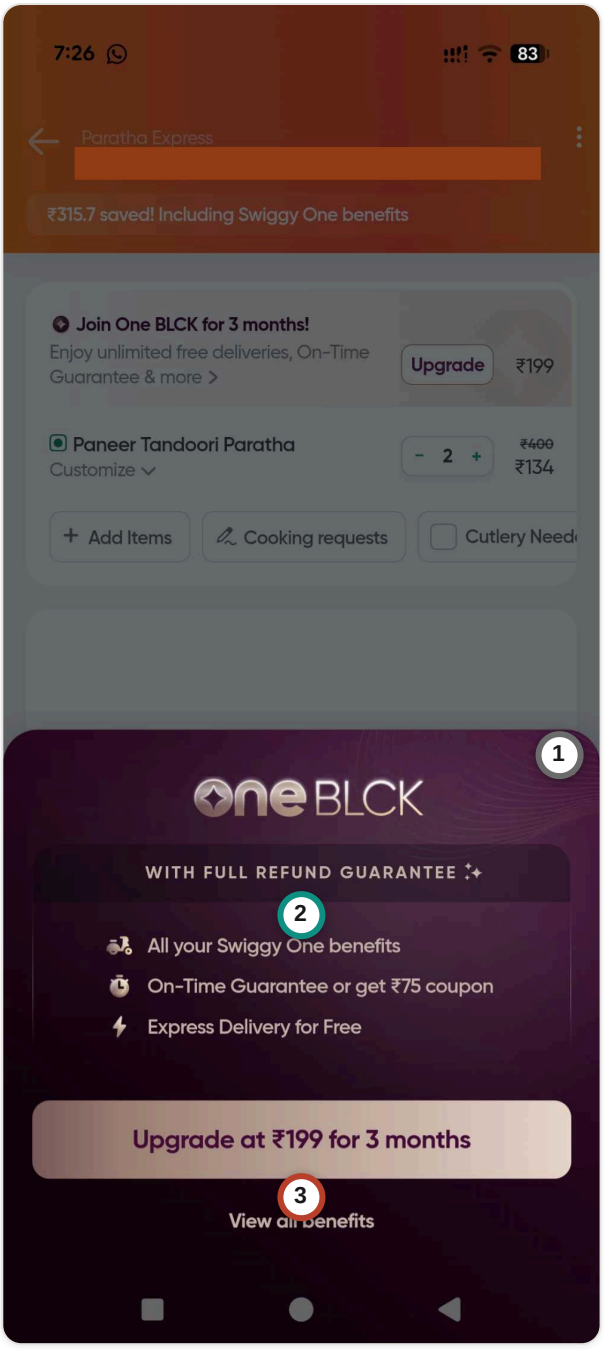
| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 3 | "✓ Surprise Deals item added — Chaap Korma & 4 Rumali Roti" | 🔴 **Extract** | A discounted deal I actively chose to add, not something the platform added on its own — worth stating precisely, since the intent here is persuasion, not deception. The checkmark and "added" framing still borrow the visual language of a completed system action, which reads as more definitive than a normal "+" add button would. |
| 4 | "SURPRISE DEALS" carousel with a 4m:2s deal-expiry countdown | 🔴 **Extract** | None of these items (Veg Biryani, Matka Biryani, Chilli Garlic, Chilli Potato) are EatRight-tagged. The countdown is a genuine expiring-discount timer, not a fake urgency device — but its placement is not neutral: it's shown to a user mid-way through a targeted order, competing for the same attention and the same budget. |

> **CORRECTING MY OWN FIRST READ**
>
> I originally read element 3 as an item added without the user's action — it wasn't. I chose that deal myself. The more accurate and, I think, more interesting finding is this: the deal is real and opt-in, but it's steeply discounted specifically on non-EatRight items, timed to appear exactly when a health-conscious user is reviewing a considered order. That's not a consent violation. It's the platform spending its persuasion budget on pulling a goal-driven user toward the exact category their goal was built to avoid.

*The single most interesting decision on this screen: three separate Extract-intent elements stack vertically in the first half of checkout, each demanding attention before the user reaches their own cart contents. The likely reason is that checkout is measured, high-intent real estate every growth team wants a share of, regardless of which tab a user arrived from. I'd still change the targeting, because a user who came from EatRight is precisely the user least likely to want a discounted biryani — showing it to them anyway is a segmentation miss, not a deliberate trap, but it costs the same either way.*

## 4.3 — Override two: a task you can't finish without a detour

**Zones on this screen:** a full-screen Extract-intent modal temporarily replaces every other zone on the page — the most aggressive placement of any monetisation element captured in this teardown.



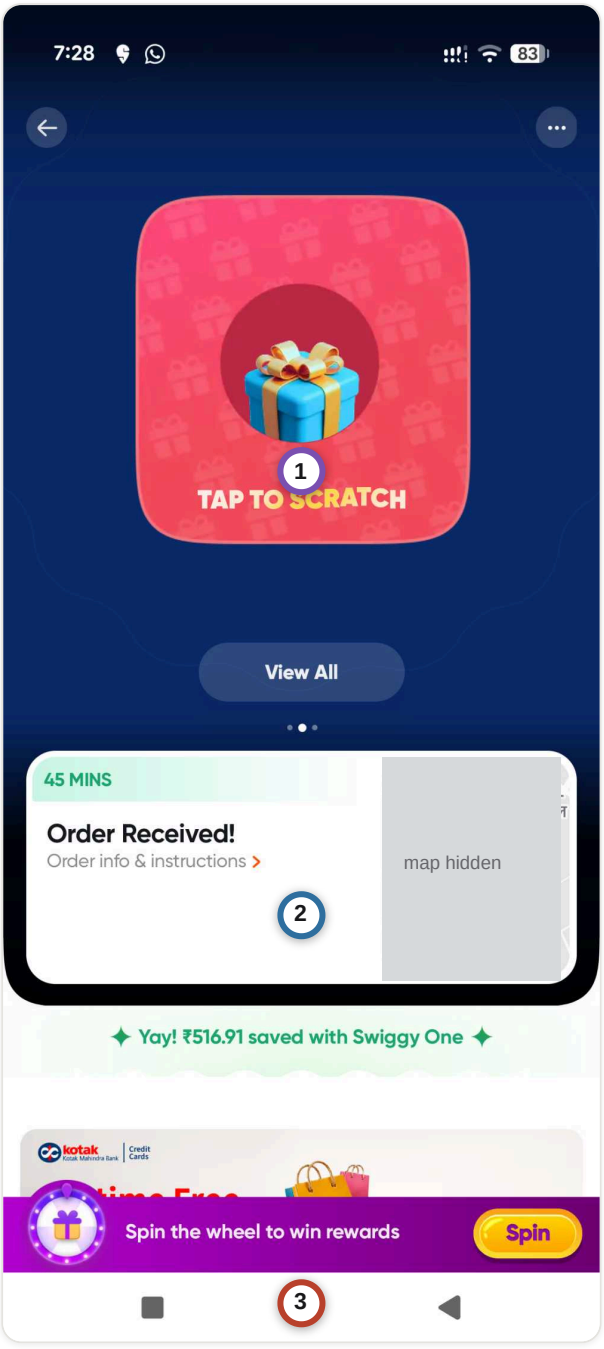

| # | ELEMENT | INTENT | WHY HERE / NOW / THIS FORM / THIS WEIGHT |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | X close button | ● **Comply** | Small, top-right corner — present, but not weighted to compete with the upgrade CTA below it. |
| 2 | "WITH FULL REFUND GUARANTEE" | ● **Reassure** | De-risks the upsell before listing benefits — reduces the perceived cost of saying yes to a modal the user didn't ask to see. |
| 3 | "Upgrade at ₹199 for 3 months" button | ● **Extract** | Full-width, high-contrast, bottom of the modal — the only large filled action on screen, competing with nothing except the small close icon. |

**WHY THIS IS WORTH FLAGGING**

> This is a full-screen interstitial that has to be actively dismissed before checkout can continue. A user mid-way through placing a considered, goal-driven order has to make a decision about an unrelated subscription before they're allowed to finish the task they came to do — the second point in one flow where the platform inserts itself between a user and the thing they're trying to finish.

## 4.4 — Override three: gamifying the moment you succeeded

**Zones on this screen:** a Retain-intent element (the scratch card) occupies the primary Content zone position immediately after order confirmation — ahead of the order status itself.




| # | ELEMENT | INTENT | WHY HERE / NOW / THIS FORM / THIS WEIGHT |
|---|---|---|---|

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | "Tap to scratch" reward card | **Retain** | Placed above the order status itself — the first thing shown after paying is a game, not confirmation that the order went through. |
| 2 | Order Received status + live map | **Orient** | Pushed below the fold relative to the scratch card — a secondary position for what is arguably the primary thing a user wants to see right after paying. |
| 3 | "Spin the wheel to win rewards" banner | **Extract** | A second gamified prompt further down the same screen — two separate reward mechanics stacked on one post-order view. |

*The single most interesting decision in this whole teardown: order confirmation — the moment of highest task-completion relief — was chosen as the placement for not one but two gamified re-engagement prompts. That's a deliberate bet that this emotional high point converts better into future engagement than a calmer confirmation would. Put this next to the checkout interstitial and the discounted-temptation carousel, and a pattern emerges that has nothing to do with nutrition: tempt with a discount on unrelated items, interrupt the task with a subscription pitch, then gamify the exact moment the user succeeded at their goal. Health was the entry point. This is the actual story.*

> *"I ordered food while trying to stay on plan, and I ended up giving in to my craving... I looked at what triggered the decision — mainly being very hungry and not having a planned option available... One unplanned meal doesn't ruin progress, but understanding the reason behind it helps prevent the same situation from repeating."*
>
> — a client I work with on a structured nutrition plan, six months in

The moments where someone's intent is most fragile — hungry, undecided, no plan ready — are exactly the moments a scratch card or a countdown timer is most effective. That's not a coincidence a product team has to work hard to create. It's the default outcome of optimising for engagement without asking who's on the other end of a specific session.

STAGE 5 · FRICTION LOG

## Every issue found, ranked by severity

**Severity key:** 5 = actively breaks the user's task or the trust in the data shown; 3 = adds friction or sends a conflicting signal; 1 = a minor inconsistency worth noting but not urgent.

| SCREEN | WHAT I WAS TRYING TO DO | WHAT HAPPENED / EXPECTED | SEVERITY |
|---|---|---|---|
| Checkout | Review my cart before paying for a health-focused order | A carousel of discounted, non-EatRight items with an expiry countdown competes for attention right where the cart is reviewed — opt-in, but targeted without regard to which tab the order started from | 3 |
| EatRight tab | Judge whether a dish fits my specific target | Same kcal/protein number shown to every user; no ingredient reasoning or explanation behind the figure | 4 |
| Home / general browsing | Order without deliberately opening EatRight first | Zero macro or calorie signal anywhere on the default path | 4 |
| Order confirmation | Confirm my health-conscious order went through | A scratch-card game appeared above the order status itself | 4 |
| Checkout | Complete a considered order | A full-screen subscription interstitial (One BLCK) interrupted the flow and had to be actively dismissed | 4 |
| EatRight tab, restaurant page | Trust an "EatRight" or "No Fry High Protein" claim | No correction link or confidence indicator anywhere in the captures — no way | 2 |

| | |
|---|---|
| | to flag a number that looks wrong |

STAGE 6 · TOP THREE PROBLEMS

## Impact against effort

| PROBLEM | WHY IT MATTERS (IMPACT) | EFFORT | PRIORITY |
|---|---|---|---|
| Full-screen subscription interstitial blocking checkout | Forces a decision on an unrelated product before the user can finish the task they came to do | Low | P0 |
| No trust-building layer behind EatRight badges | A number with no explanation is easy to distrust, and there's no correction mechanism if it's wrong | Medium | P0 |
| Gamified re-engagement timed to order confirmation | Works against, not with, a user whose actual goal is to order less often | Medium | P1 |

STAGE 7 · THE REBUILD

## Keep, kill, change, move, add

| VERDICT | ELEMENT | INTENT | EXPECTED METRIC IMPACT | TRADE-OFF | COUNTER-ARGUMENT |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Keep** | Card-level kcal/protein badges in EatRight and on restaurant pages | Reassure | Maintains current EatRight engagement baseline | None significant — this part already works | Some may argue it should be redesigned entirely rather than kept as-is, given the trust gap identified |
| **Change** | Discounted "Surprise Deals" carousel shown | Extract | Should reduce the share of attention/budget | Loses a proven upsell mechanic that likely drives | The mechanic may already be net-positive for |

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | regardless of which tab the order started from | | pulled away from health-tagged items on EatRight-originated checkouts | real incremental AOV on non-EatRight orders | overall revenue — suppressing it only for EatRight-originated orders is a segmentation change, not a removal, and needs real data before committing |
| **Change** | EatRight badges from bare numbers to numbers + a brief "why" explanation | Reassure | Should reduce distrust and increase repeat EatRight tab visits | Requires new content for every EatRight-tagged dish — a real content-ops lift | Restaurants may not have reliable ingredient-level data to support this at scale, which could mean the explanation ends up as generic as the badge it's meant to improve |
| **Move** | EatRight from a secondary sub-nav row into the primary bottom navigation | Orient | Should increase EatRight tab discovery and session entry rate | Bottom nav real estate is scarce and contested by other initiatives | A lower-traffic feature may not deserve primary nav placement until it proves engagement first |
| **Add** | A correction link on every EatRight nutrition claim | Comply, Reassure | Should surface and eventually reduce inaccurate EatRight tags over time | Requires a review/moderation process on the backend to action reports | Low report volume in early days could make this feel like unused surface area rather than a meaningful trust signal |

STAGE 8 · PRIORITISE AND PROVE

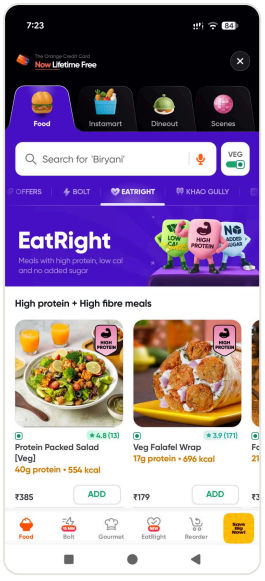
# Experiments I'd run before shipping any of this

| HYPOTHESIS | PRIMARY METRIC | GUARDRAIL | SAMPLE / DURATION | IF IT COMES BACK FLAT |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| If we suppress the discounted, non-EatRight "Surprise Deals" carousel on EatRight-originated checkouts, then checkout completion rate and post-purchase satisfaction on those orders will rise, because a goal-driven user won't be shown a targeted temptation away from their stated goal | Checkout completion rate on EatRight-originated carts, target +5% relative | Average order value on Surprise Deals overall must not fall by more than the completion-rate gain justifies | All EatRight-originated checkouts, 3-week test | Most likely explanation is that most users simply ignore the carousel rather than feeling conflicted by it — check carousel engagement rate specifically before concluding the suppression mattered either way |
| If we add a brief "why this is tagged EatRight" explanation to dish cards, then EatRight tab return-visit rate will rise, because the badge becomes something a user can evaluate rather than just accept | EatRight tab WAU/MAU ratio, target +8pp | Dish page load time must not slow down | ~15k EatRight-tab visitors, 4-week test | Re-test with the explanation made more visually prominent — a flat result may mean it wasn't noticed, not that explanation itself doesn't help |
| If we suppress the scratch-card and spin-the-wheel prompts specifically on EatRight-originated orders, then next-session return time for that cohort will not shorten meaningfully, disproving the assumption that gamification drives incremental re-engagement for this specific user type | Days-to-next-order for EatRight-originated users, target: no significant change | Overall gamification engagement (non-EatRight cohort) must stay flat as a control | ~10k EatRight-originated orders, 4-week test | If return time does shorten, that's evidence the gamification is genuinely additive even for this cohort, and the recommendation to suppress it should be reversed |

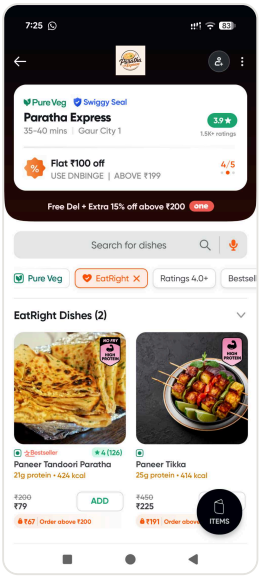
APPENDIX

# Key evidence

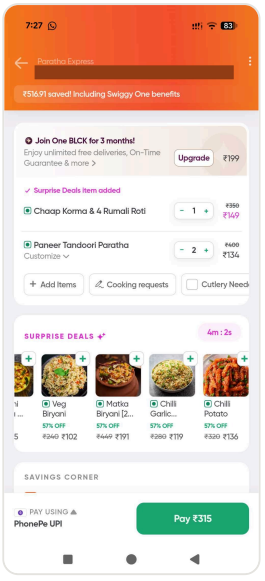
Six screens carrying the core findings, from twelve captured live on a personal order.



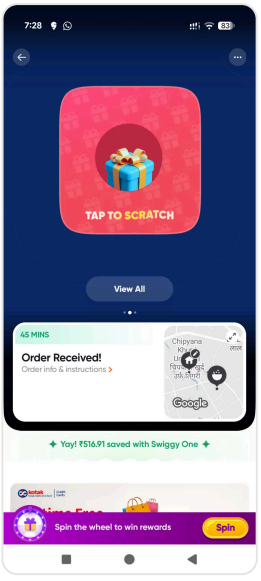

EatRight tab: a number, with no explanation behind it



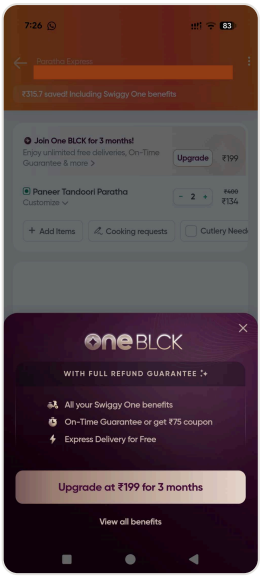

EatRight filter treated as a generic result count



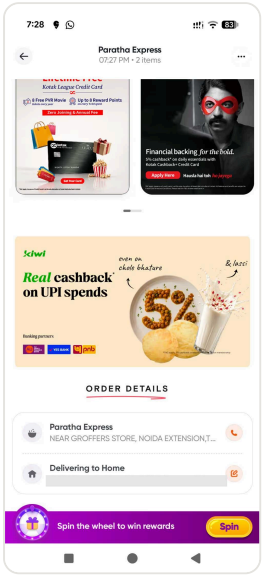

Discounted, non-health items competing for attention at checkout




A scratch card ranked above the order status itself




Full-screen subscription interstitial blocking checkout




Order details: ads and cashback offers surfacing the business layer

**Closing note:** the honest read on EatRight isn't "Swiggy doesn't care about health-conscious users" — it's that the feature currently stops at showing a number, with no explanation behind it and no protection from the rest of the app's growth mechanics. A scratch card above the order status and a full-screen subscription pitch mid-checkout suggest the feature hasn't yet been designed to hold its own against the platform's other incentives.

Written self-initiated, September 2026, from twelve screens captured on my own order.